

Jhuming Agriculture

*Shifting cultivation is a practice in which an area of forest is cleared and cultivated by tribes and when the fertility of that area degrades the people shift to other places until its fertility has been naturally restored. It is known by different names in different regions such as **Jhum** in the north-east state, **pondu** in Odisha, **Kumari** in western Ghats etc.

Shifting cultivation	Region
Jhum	North-east states
Kumari	Western Ghats
Waltre	Rajasthan
Dahiya	Madhya Pradesh
Podu	Odisha
Mashan	Madhya Pradesh
Poonam	Kerala
Bewar	Madhya Pradesh
Podu/Penda	Andhra Pradesh
Kuruwa	Jharkhand
Koman/Bringa	Odisha
Khil	Himalayan belt

1. What is Jhuming (also known as Paida) system?

- (a) Cutting of jungle and leaving it to dry
- (b) Excessive use of chemical fertiliser
- (c) Irrigation
- (d) Dry farming

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

Jhuming is a type of shifting cultivation that is done by the tribes by clearing the forests. When fertility of that place degrades they shift to another place and the same procedure is followed again and again.

2. Jhoom is -

- (a) A type of folk dance
- (b) Name of a river
- (c) A tribe in the North-East
- (d) A type of agriculture (cultivation)

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. What is 'Jhum'?

- (a) A folk dance
- (b) The name of a river valley
- (c) A tribe
- (d) A type of cultivation

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Jhuming is practised mostly in

- (a) Assam
- (b) Andhra Pradesh
- (c) Nagaland
- (d) Madhya Pradesh

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

Jhuming cultivation is practised mostly in hilly areas of north-eastern States. It is more prevalent in Nagaland, Arunachal Pradesh and Meghalaya. In the hilly regions of Assam also, Jhum cultivation is also practiced by the tribals.

5. Slash and burn agriculture, commonly called as Jhum cultivation is practiced in the-

- (a) North eastern States of India
- (b) North western States of India
- (c) Western coast of India
- (d) None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

Slash and burn agriculture, commonly called as Jhum cultivation practiced in the North eastern states of India like Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram and Nagaland, Tripura, Sikkim Pamlou in Manipur etc. Slash and burn agriculture, farmers clear a patch of land and produce cereals and other food crops to sustain their family. When the Soil Fertility decrease, the farmers shift and clear a fresh patch of land for cultivation. This type of shifting allows nature to replenish the fertility of the soil through natural process, land productivity in this type of agriculture is low as the farmer does not use fertiliser or other modern inputs.

6. Jhum cultivation is a problem in the hilly areas of -

- (a) Assam and Bihar
- (b) Bihar and Odisha
- (c) Odisha and Madhya Pradesh
- (d) Maharashtra and U.P.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (a)

When the question was asked option (a) was correct answer. Currently, its answer would be Odisha and Madhya Pradesh.

7. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer by using the codes given below:

List-I	List-II
A. Western Ghat	1. Dahiya
B. South-east Rajasthan	2. Waltre
C. North-east India	3. Jhum
D. Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh	4. Kumari